

Section B: Promoting Media

In this section, learners are required to study the following media forms:

- Film
- Advertising and marketing; and
- Video games

The table below illustrates the areas of the media theoretical framework that need to be studied for each of the three media forms:

Media Forms	Film	Advertising and marketing	Video games
Set Media Products	<i>The Lego Movie</i> (2014), U, Warner Bros	<i>Posters for The Lego Movie</i> and UK TV trailer	<i>The Lego Movie Video Game</i>
Media Language		✓	✓
Media Representations		✓	
Media Industries	✓		✓
Media Audiences		✓	✓
Media contexts	Social, Cultural	Social, Cultural	Social, Cultural

Film: *The Lego Movie* (2014), U, Warner Bros

The Lego Movie must be studied in relation to media industries only. Learners need to study the set film in relation to **all** the subject content bullet points listed under the 'media industries' topic in the subject content table at the end of Component 01.

The Lego Movie (2014) illustrates the concept of tent-pole² film production by media conglomerates, in this case Warner Bros. Its success was of major importance to the studio in terms of funding other projects.

The film is also an example of how a global studio, Warner Bros, releases a film in a specific national territory, the UK. There are also questions of ownership and purpose of the film, e.g. tension between Lego and Warner Bros both using the film to promote their own products through use of iconic characters e.g. Batman, Superman and numerous Lego toy models. The film has a clear pattern of production, distribution and circulation that can be easily distinguished and is a film production from a major, global studio.

Learners must investigate how the elements of the theoretical framework for media industries can be considered in relation to how the set film was produced, distributed and circulated, including considerations such as conglomerate ownership and how media companies operate on a global scale, convergence, funding and, regulation.

Extracts of the film may only be considered in relation to media industry issues exemplified. Textual analysis is **not** a requirement of the study or assessment of Film as a media form.

Advertising and marketing: *The Lego Movie* (2014) Posters and UK TV trailer

Advertising and marketing must be studied in relation to media language, media representations and media audiences.

Learners need to study:

- the set *The Lego Movie* (2014) posters; and
- the UK TV trailer <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HSbYBzUEQIc>

Learners need to study the set advertising and marketing products in relation to **all** the subject content bullet points listed under 'media language' and 'media representations' topics in the subject content table at the end of Component 01.

In addition, learners also need to study the following two bullet points from the 'media audience' subject content:

- the ways in which media organisations target audiences through marketing, including an understanding about the assumptions organisations make about their target audience(s)
- the ways in which audiences may interpret the same media products very differently and how these differences may reflect both social and individual differences.

Learners must investigate how the elements of the theoretical framework for media language are used to construct representations that target particular audiences. Consideration should be made of media language elements specific to posters and moving image trailers such as locations, costumes, choice of camera shot, angle, lighting, typography, layout, editing and sound as appropriate.

The set promotional posters are:

1. The main poster featuring an ensemble cast, running from danger
2. Character poster of Vitruvius in close-up
3. Character poster of Emmet in close-up
4. Character poster of Lord Business in close-up
5. Character poster of Wyldstyle in close-up.

Information on where to find these can be found in Appendix 5e.

Video games: *The Lego Movie Game* (2014), TT Games (A Warner Bros. Subsidiary)

Video games must be studied in relation to media industries, media audiences and media language.

The Lego Movie video game is an example of successful vertical integration where a subsidiary of a global media producer, Warner Bros, has been used to produce a video game linked directly to the release of the motion picture of the same name, with the video game sharing similar themes and voice acting by stars of the motion picture as they reprise their characters in the video game. *The Lego Movie* video game is also an example of a successful cross platform release.

Learners must study the set video game product in relation to **all** the subject content bullet points listed under the 'media industries' and 'media audiences' topics in the subject content table at the end of Component 01.

In addition learners also need to study the following bullet point from the 'media language' subject content:

- intertextuality, including how inter-relationships between different media products can influence meaning.

Learners must consider the elements of the theoretical framework for media industries and audiences and examine how the producers of *The Lego Movie Game* have engaged with and identified their audience and examine issues of ownership and how these influenced the production, distribution and release of the game. Learners should also consider the relationship between technology and the video game and intertextual meanings generated, for example, to other Warner Bros franchises and to Lego as a product itself.

Extracts of the video game must only be considered in relation to the media industry, audience and language issues exemplified.

In Component 01, learners will develop knowledge and understanding of the following subject content in relation to the relevant set media products:

Topic	Key idea	Learners must demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:
Media language	Media language elements	- the various forms of media language used to create and communicate meanings in media products - fundamental principles of semiotic analysis, including denotation and connotation.
	Media language and meaning	how choice (selection, combination and exclusion) of elements of media language influences meaning in media products, including to create narratives, to portray aspects of reality, to construct points of view, and to represent the world in ways that convey messages and values.
	Technology	the relationship between technology and media products.
	Genre	- the codes and conventions of media language, how they develop and become established as 'styles' or genres (which are common across different media products) and how they may also vary over time - theoretical perspectives on genre, including principles of repetition and variation; the dynamic nature of genre; hybridity and intertextuality.
	Intertextuality	intertextuality, including how inter-relationships between different media products can influence meaning.
Media representations	Narrative	theories of narrative, including those derived from Propp.
	Mediation	- the ways in which the media re-present (rather than simply present) the world, and construct versions of reality - the choices media producers make about how to represent particular events, social groups and ideas - the ways aspects of reality may be represented differently depending on the purposes of the producers - theoretical perspectives on representation, including processes of selection, construction and mediation.
	Stereotypes	the different functions and uses of stereotypes, including an understanding of how stereotypes become established, how they may vary over time, and how stereotypes enable audiences to interpret media quickly.
	Inequality in representation	- how and why particular social groups may be under-represented or misrepresented - theoretical perspectives on gender and representation, including feminist approaches.

Topic	Key idea	Learners must demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:
Media representations	Themes and ideologies	• how representations (including self-representations) convey particular viewpoints, messages, values and beliefs, which may be reinforced across a wide range of media products • the social, cultural and political significance of particular representations in terms of the themes or issues that they address • theoretical perspectives on gender and representation, including the feminist concept of patriarchy.
	Representation and context	• how representations reflect the social, historical and cultural contexts in which they were produced.
	Representation and audience	• the factors affecting audience interpretations of representations, including their own experiences and beliefs.
Media industries	Media producers	• the nature of media production, including by large organisations, who own the products they produce, and by individuals and groups.
		• the impact of production processes, personnel and technologies on the final product, including similarities and differences between media products in terms of when and where they are produced.
	Ownership and control	• the effect of ownership and control of media organisations, including conglomerate ownership, diversification and vertical integration.
	Convergence	• the impact of the increasingly convergent nature of media industries across different platforms and different national settings.
	Funding	• the importance of different funding models, including government funded, not-for-profit and commercial models.
	Industries and audiences	• how the media operate as commercial industries on a global scale and reach both large and specialised audiences.
	Media regulation	• the functions and types of regulation of the media.
		• the challenges for media regulation presented by 'new' digital technologies.

Topic	Key idea	Learners must demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:
Media audiences	Targeting audiences	how and why media products are aimed at a range of audiences, from small, specialised audiences to large mass audiences.
		how media organisations categorise audiences.
		the ways in which media organisations target audiences through marketing, including an understanding of the assumptions organisations make about their target audience(s).
	Technologies	the role of media technologies in reaching and identifying audiences, and in audience consumption and usage.
	Active audiences	- the ways in which audiences may interpret the same media products very differently and how these differences may reflect both social and individual differences - theoretical perspectives on audiences, including active and passive audiences; audience response and audience interpretation.
	Uses and gratifications	- the social, cultural and political significance of media products, including the themes or issues they address, the fulfilment of needs and desires, and the functions they serve in everyday life and society - the ways in which people's media practices are connected to their identity, including their sense of actual and desired self - Blumler and Katz's Uses and Gratifications theory.
	Changing audience responses	how audiences may respond to and interpret media products and why these responses and interpretations may change over time.
Contexts	Social	how media products reflect the society in which they are produced and that of their target audience.
	Cultural	how media products reflect the arts and culture, including popular culture, of their time.
	Historical	how media products reflect historical events and social changes.
	Political	how media products reflect political viewpoints, messages, values and beliefs.